

THE SAN MIGUEL EDITION

Moving to San Miguel

Residency · Healthcare · Banking
The First 30 Days · A Practical Guide

FROM EXPATERS TO ADVICE EXPERTS: HOW TO SUCCEED

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Residency

Most long-term residents enter Mexico on a temporary or permanent resident visa, applied for at a Mexican consulate in their home country before arrival — not after landing.

- Temporary resident visas typically run 1–4 years and are renewable
- Permanent residency is available to those who qualify financially or after several years on temporary status
- Requirements are financial (income or savings thresholds) and documentary — check current figures with your nearest consulate

GOOD TO KNOW

Start this process before you move, not after — consulate appointments and processing add real lead time.

Healthcare

Many residents use a mix of Mexican private insurance and out-of-pocket care, which is often more affordable than what they budgeted coming from the U.S. or Canada.

San Miguel has solid local clinics and specialists, with larger hospitals a reasonable drive away in Querétaro or León for more complex care. Most long-term residents keep a relationship with both a local general practitioner and a specialist network in a nearby city.

Banking

Opening a Mexican bank account is straightforward once you have residency paperwork in hand — trying to open one beforehand is usually more friction than it's worth.

- Bring your passport, proof of address, and residency card (or in-process documentation) to the branch
- Many residents keep accounts in both currencies — a home-country account for savings, a Mexican account for daily spending
- Wire transfers for a home purchase typically move through the notario's escrow process, not a personal account

BLAZE BEASLEY REAL ESTATE

Have Questions Before You Move?

I'm happy to walk through your specific situation — visas, timing, or anything else on your mind.

[Book a Relocation Call](#)

Internet, Cell Service & Utilities

Internet

Fiber and cable internet are widely available in most established neighborhoods, with speeds that comfortably support remote work and video calls.

Cell Service

Major Mexican carriers offer affordable prepaid and postpaid plans; an unlocked phone from home usually works fine with a local SIM.

Utilities

Electricity, water, and gas are typically set up directly with the provider once you have a signed lease or deed — your notario or property manager can usually help coordinate this.

Transportation

Centro is genuinely walkable, and many residents in outer neighborhoods still choose to keep a car for groceries, errands, and exploring beyond the historic core.

- Importing a foreign-plated car long-term requires permitting — many residents instead buy locally after arrival
- Ride-hailing apps operate in San Miguel and are a reliable option for evenings out
- Cobblestone streets are hard on low-clearance vehicles — worth considering when choosing a car

Schools

Families relocating with children have several bilingual and international school options, most concentrated in or near Guadiana and Atascadero.

Enrollment windows and curricula vary — it's worth reaching out directly to shortlisted schools early in your planning, since some fill ahead of the academic year.

Pets

Cats and dogs generally need an updated vaccination record and a health certificate issued shortly before travel; requirements can shift, so confirm current rules with your airline and a vet experienced in international pet travel.

GOOD TO KNOW

San Miguel is a notably pet-friendly city — many cafés and even some shops welcome well-behaved dogs.

The First 30 Days

- Register with your home country's local consulate, if one operates in the region
- Get a local phone plan and, if applicable, begin your CURP (population registry number) paperwork
- Open a local bank account once residency documents are in hand
- Set up utilities and internet at your new home
- Find a local grocery routine — markets, tiendas, and delivery apps all play a role
- Give yourself permission to move at San Miguel's pace — most transplants say this is the biggest adjustment, and the one they come to love most

Neighborhood Guide

A quick reference for where different lifestyles tend to land in San Miguel.



Centro
HISTORIC HEART



San Antonio
ARTISTIC & BOHEMIAN



Guadiana
RESIDENTIAL & QUIET



Atascadero
PANORAMIC VIEWS



Balcones
UPSCALE & GATED



Los Frailes
GROWING VALUE

Local Recommendations

A short, illustrative starter list — not exhaustive, and worth building on once you've settled in.

- **Saturday mornings** — the Mercado de Artesanías for crafts and produce
- **Coffee** — several independent roasters within a few blocks of the jardín
- **Galleries** — Fábrica La Aurora, a converted textile mill turned arts complex
- **Community** — local Facebook groups and expat meetups are often the fastest way to get plugged in

THANK YOU

Welcome to San Miguel

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